

STARTUPS



Pocketaalk

Made by SourceNext, a Japanese startup, Pocketaalk is translator that can interpret 74 different languages. It comes with a global SIM card and sports a simple interface that consists of a two-way speaker and dual microphones with active noise cancellation to ensure a seamless and accurate conversation between individuals.

PRICE: \$299



Chris

While Google, Amazon, Microsoft and Apple's digital assistants become all-pervasive, some have chosen to remain focused on their domain. Developed by Berlin-based startup, German Autolabs, Chris is a standalone device that helps you to make calls, send messages and all the usual stuff that voice assistants do. It can process verbal commands in Eng-

lish and German, currently. So what makes Chris stand out? For a start, it has support for gestures so it's obviously helpful for the impaired. And if gestures aren't your thing, then the great thing about Chris is that it can perform all of its functions without being connected to the Internet. Take that Alexa!

PRICE: 159 Euros (Kickstarter)

Flux Planet

Flux Planet, based in Seoul and formed by a bunch of ex-Samsung employees built a 4D scanner and 3D projector that is capable of mapping and rendering AR/VR content. For \$50,000, you can get your hands on a HiFi 4D scanner. It's capable of capturing 3D data in real time. Imagine having one of these devices at your local game store and getting yourself digitised into your in-game avatar. Fun!



Mitra

With the aim of better engagement, Mitra by Invento Robotics, is ... well a robot that can interact better with your customers, employees and patrons as against an app on a tablet. By putting an AI capable of face recognition and holding conversations, this humanoid entity is all about connecting with you in a more personal manner. If you step into your local HDFC bank or PVR cinema theatre, you might even spot Mitra in India or his friend, Mitri.



Bell.AI

This one is for the kids at CES, Bell.AI and Bell the robot are gadgets designed to help kids learn about the basics of programming and robotics. Their Mabot robot kit is a modular system that lets kids build, customise and code their own programs. It's even compatible with LEGO, the popular building toy, and Scratch, an equally popular drag-and-drop IDE.